

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | SIEM/XDR Deployment | MDR |
Enterprise-Scale Security Operations

United Kingdom (Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprospers

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with more than five years of experience designing, deploying, and optimising Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) solutions at enterprise scale. I have deep hands-on expertise across the full Microsoft Defender suite, including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, and Microsoft 365 Defender, combined with advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) proficiency and strong PowerShell scripting skills for detection engineering and SOAR automation. At the University of the Arts London, I led the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Sentinel across more than 8,000 users, engineering detection use-cases, onboarding and managing log sources, integrating Microsoft Security and Azure product stacks, and building Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks for automated threat containment. I lead Level 3 (L3) incident investigations and conduct advanced threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework, operating across cloud and hybrid environments. I am experienced in defining and delivering operational and executive-level security dashboards and reporting, and in mentoring junior security engineers. I am seeking a fully remote permanent Senior Security Engineer role with a leading Managed Detection and Response (MDR) provider where I can apply my Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR expertise to protect enterprise customer environments at scale.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM:** End-to-end deployment, log source onboarding, data connector management, KQL analytics rules, SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps), workbooks and dashboards, ingestion cost optimisation
- **Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft 365 Defender, advanced hunting, use-case tuning
- **SIEM/XDR Integration:** Microsoft Security and Azure product stack integration, cross-platform log source management, signal correlation across cloud and hybrid environments
- **Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection use-cases, KQL-based threat hunting, detection-as-code lifecycle, TTP-based alerting, hypothesis-driven investigations
- **Incident Investigation and Response:** L3 incident response, NIST 800-61, root-cause analysis, multi-cloud threat correlation, post-incident review and lessons-learned
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation workflows, alert enrichment and automated containment
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Azure security architecture, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, cloud-native security controls
- **Dashboards and Reporting:** Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, operational security dashboards, executive-level reporting and KPI development
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover; Falcon Fusion SOAR
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) ~~Senior Security Analyst~~

March 2025 - Present

- Lead the deployment and ongoing management of Microsoft Sentinel as UAL's enterprise SIEM, onboarding and managing more than 20 data connectors across Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365,

CrowdStrike, and on-premise sources, engineering detection use-cases aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.

- Administer the Microsoft Defender XDR stack (MDE, MDI, Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft 365 Defender) across more than 8,000 users, managing advanced hunting queries, threat analytics, and SIEM/XDR integrations across Microsoft Security and Azure product stacks.
- Engineer and optimise Sentinel SIEM and Defender XDR use-cases, continuously tuning detection logic and SOAR playbooks (Logic Apps) to improve fidelity, reduce false-positive rates, and enable automated threat containment.
- Define, build, and maintain Microsoft Sentinel workbooks for operational security monitoring and executive-level dashboards, providing clear visibility of security posture, incident trends, and key risk indicators to senior leadership.
- Lead L3 incident investigations across cloud and hybrid environments, correlating Sentinel, Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike signals to identify root cause, contain threats, and produce detailed post-incident reports.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting in KQL, developing and sharing reusable hunt queries across endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry to proactively identify adversary activity not surfaced by automated detections.
- Manage ingestion costs and log source strategy for Microsoft Sentinel, regularly reviewing data connector configurations and workspace settings to optimise the cost-to-coverage ratio without reducing detection capability.
- Build and maintain SOAR automation workflows using PowerShell and Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, triage routing, and containment actions to increase SOC efficiency and reduce mean time to respond.
- Mentor junior security analysts in KQL, detection engineering, and incident investigation techniques, developing their skills through hands-on guidance and structured knowledge-sharing sessions.

University of the Arts London (UAL) **Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged Microsoft Sentinel analytics rule alerts, using KQL to investigate triggered detections across endpoint, identity, and cloud data sources and escalating confirmed incidents for L3 response.
- Supported the onboarding of new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, validating data connector configurations and working with infrastructure teams to ensure complete telemetry coverage.
- Contributed to detection engineering, proposing and building new KQL analytics rules informed by threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK techniques, and threat hunting findings.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity, managing detection policies, reviewing incident queues, and supporting deployment and integration activities.
- Participated in incident response exercises and live incidents, developing skills in log-based investigation, malware analysis, and post-incident documentation.
- Managed vulnerability scanning with Tenable.io and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams and contributing to the organisation's ongoing risk reduction programme.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS FinTech) **Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure**

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed security monitoring and controls across cloud and on-premise infrastructure for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech organisation, supporting early-stage SIEM deployment and identity security implementation.
- Supported Microsoft 365 and Azure cloud administration, managing identity and access controls and contributing to security baseline implementation across the hybrid environment.
- Contributed to GDPR compliance and data protection initiatives, supporting risk assessments, security policy development, and audit preparation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise deployment and full configuration of Microsoft Sentinel at UAL, onboarding 20+ data connectors, engineering a library of custom MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules, and implementing SOAR playbooks that significantly reduced mean alert triage time.

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across more than 8,000 users, enabling integrated XDR coverage and advanced hunting across the full Microsoft Defender stack.
- Built and maintain an executive-level Microsoft Sentinel workbook suite delivering clear visualisation of security posture, incident volumes, and vulnerability trends to the UAL senior leadership team.
- Developed a SOAR-driven automated containment workflow in Logic Apps and PowerShell that automatically isolates compromised endpoints on confirmed malware detections, reducing attacker dwell time.
- Established a regular structured threat hunting programme in Microsoft Sentinel, producing documented KQL hunt queries aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, with multiple hunts resulting in new analytics rules and improvements to detection coverage.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000 - GBP90,000 | Remote (UK)